stack

Own it. Play it everywhere.

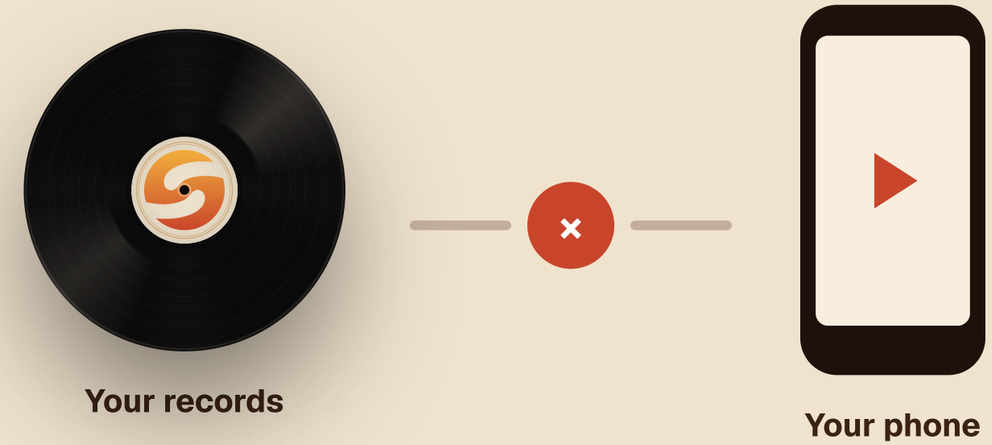
The vinyl and CDs on your shelf, playable on your phone, shared with your family, and sold on when you're done.

Harrison Greener · Student ID 214313327



You own the record.
You still pay to hear it.

Records and phones don't talk to each other. Own *The Dark Side of the Moon* on vinyl, and you still pay a streaming service to hear it on the bus.



Owning the record unlocks it everywhere.

Add a record once by barcode, Discogs or the Puck, and it plays on every device, for your whole family.



Your collection

Browse covers, a crate or a list

Play anywhere

Every record you own, in lossless

Share it

Family, friends and the Marketplace

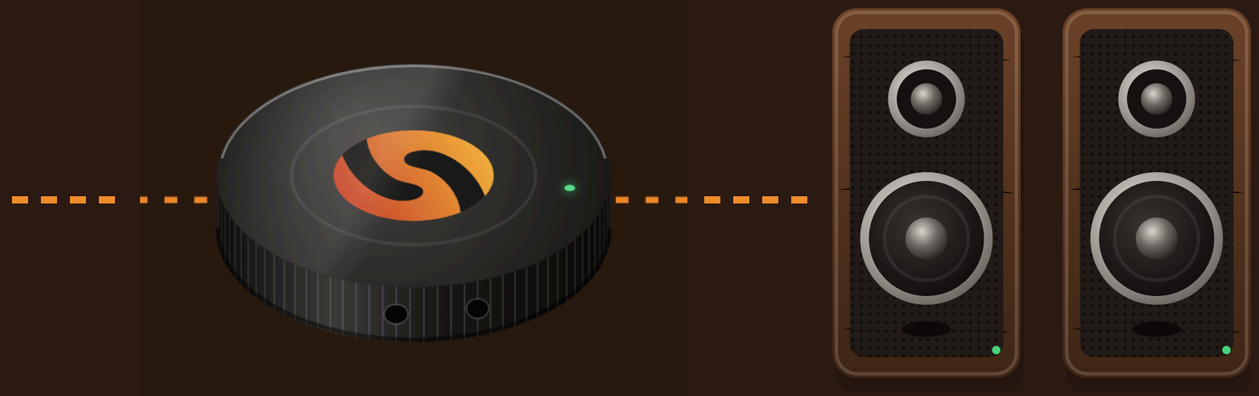
A spin becomes your own copy.

Sound passes through
Untouched, to your speakers

Records your copy
Hi-res, crackle and all

From £30
Or 3 for £75

The Puck sits between your turntable and speakers. Sound passes straight through while it records your copy in hi-res, crackle and all, and logs every play.

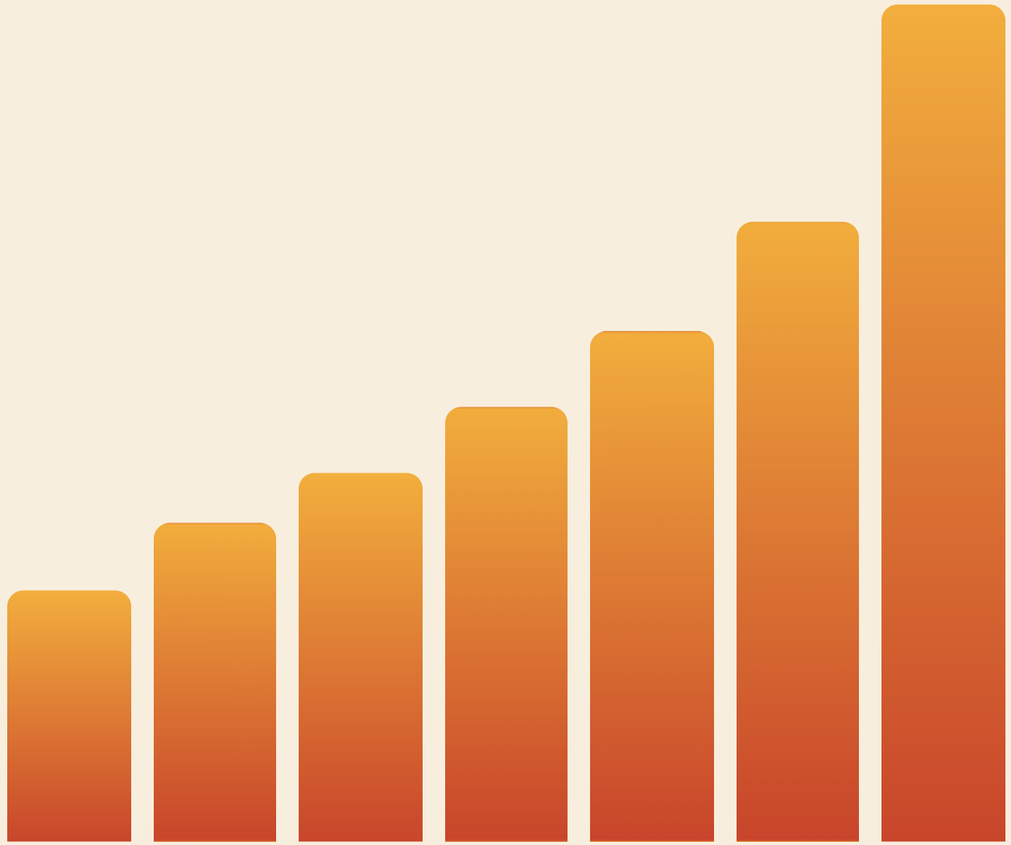


£174.4m

UK vinyl sales in 2025.

Up 19.9% in a year, the highest in around 30 years.
Collectors want to own music again.

Sources: BPI (2026); Marsden (2026). Bars show the trend.



+19.9%
growth in a year

11 years
of growth in UK recorded music

05 How it earns

One loop, four ways in.

Each part feeds the next. Your own music is free; Stack earns when people share, buy a Puck or trade records.

Also earning: Seller Pro · Stack Supply · Record shop partners



06 Pricing

Your music is free. Sharing it is what you pay for.

Just you

Solo

Free

Every record you own, anywhere, in lossless, with no ads

2 people, one home

Duo

£10/month

One shared Stack for two

Up to 4 people

Family

£19.99/month

Everyone streams everything the family owns

The Puck £30, 2 for £50, 3 for £75

Marketplace 8% seller fee, payment held until it arrives

Seller Pro £6.99/month, 5% fee

Stack Supply clothing and gear

07 Lean Canvas

The whole model, on one page.

Lean Canvas after Maurya (2012).

Problem

- You own the record but pay again to stream it
- Records and phones don’t talk to each other
- Collections sit on a shelf, unshared

Solution

- Add once by barcode, Discogs or the Puck
- Play in lossless on any device
- Share with family, sell on when done

Key metrics

- People on Stack
- Shared homes paying
- Pucks sold
- Marketplace sales

Unique value

Own it. Play it everywhere.

The records you own: playable, shareable and sellable, in one app

Unfair advantage

- The Puck links a real turntable to the app
- A working prototype, already tested

Channels

- Manchester record shops
- Record Store Day
- TikTok and Instagram
- Invite a friend

Customer segments

- Vinyl and CD collectors
- Families sharing one collection
- Record shops selling second-hand
- Early adopters: Manchester collectors and students

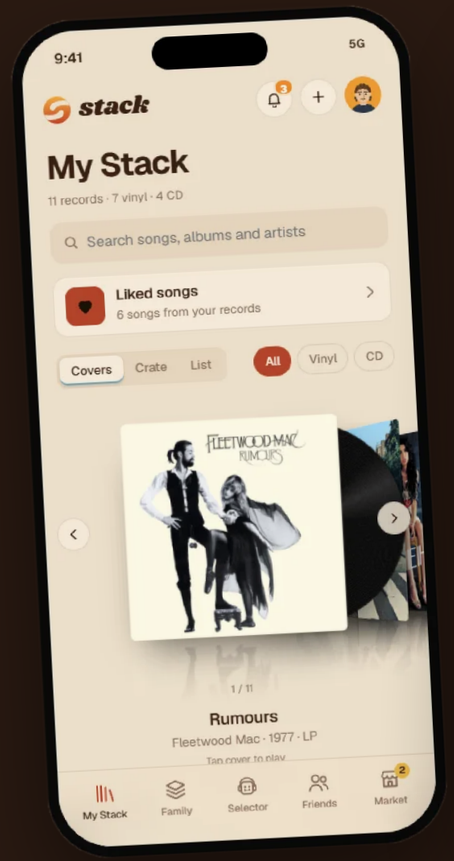
Cost structure

- Label licensing and royalties
- Making and certifying the Puck
- Hosting and lossless storage
- Marketing and shop partnerships

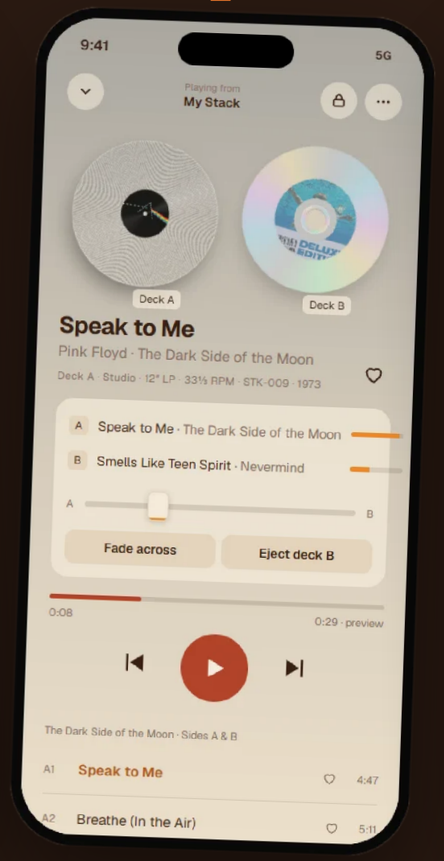
Revenue streams

- Duo £10 and Family £19.99 a month
- The Puck from £30
- 8% Marketplace fee, or Seller Pro £6.99 a month
- Stack Supply and shop partners

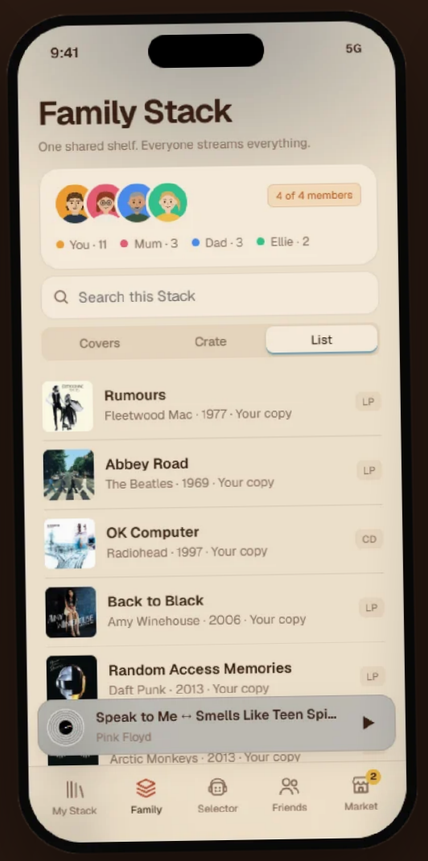
A working app, not a mockup.



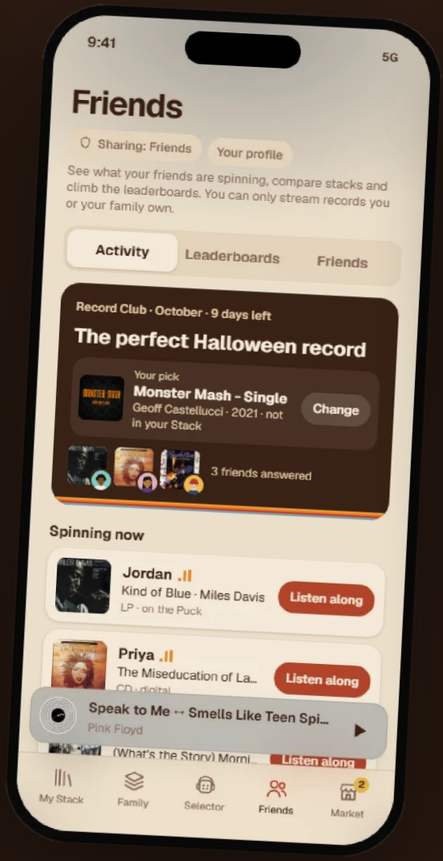
My Stack



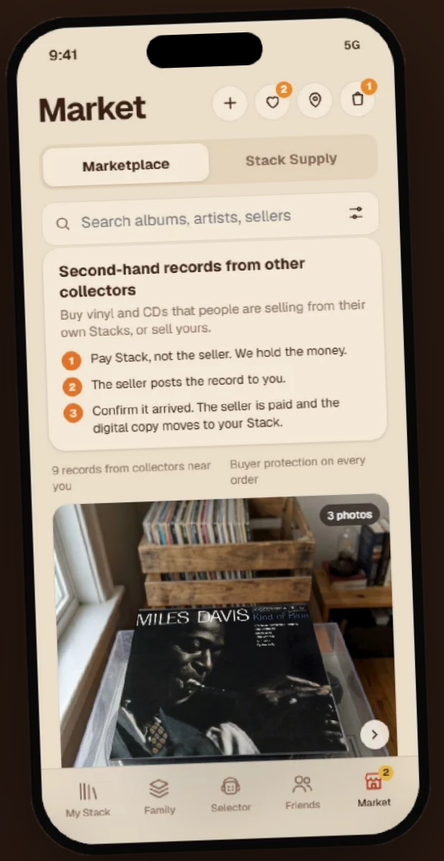
Two decks



Family Stack



Friends



Marketplace

What testers said.

“I think this is something young people will really connect with. I’d definitely use it myself to help sell for my business.”

P1 · 48, vinyl shop owner

“The interface is so much better than other vinyl collecting apps. This is something I’d use, and I’d probably share records with my sister.”

P2 · 20, freelancer

“Why doesn’t this already exist?”

P3 · 31, teacher

10 Who tested

11 testers, aged 20 to 65.

11 testers

10 on their own phones

6 changes made

Tester	Who	When	How	What they said	What changed
P4	20, waitress	Early Oct	Own phone	Old colours looked like an adult website's branding; the Puck at £70 was too expensive	**70s palette (8 Oct); Puck £30 (19 Oct)**
P7	29, doctor	Early Oct	Own phone	It wasn't clear what the app was	**Intro film (8 Oct)**
P9	65, retired teacher	Early Oct	Own phone	The way you view records was confusing	**List view, then crate view (8 Oct)**
P2	20, freelancer	About 15 Oct	Own phone	Better than other vinyl apps; wanted social features and a marketplace	**Marketplace (17 Oct); Friends (19 Oct)**
P5, P6, P8, P10, P11	Aged 21 to 59	10 to 20 Oct	Own phones	Liked it; no changes suggested	**None**
P1	48, vinyl shop owner	21 Oct	Used it on my phone, at a uni vinyl pop-up	Young people would connect with it; he'd use it to sell	**None: confirmed the Marketplace**
P3	31, teacher	21 Oct	Own phone	"Why doesn't this already exist?"	**None: confirmed the problem**

All prototype tests, October 2026. Names withheld.

11 Iteration

What testing changed.

Build → Measure → Learn → **Change**

Build, measure, learn after Ries (2011).

Feedback
A tester said the first orange and black look resembled an adult website's branding.

What changed
A warm 70s palette
Cream, sunset orange and walnut, closer to record culture.

In the app from 8 Oct

Feedback
A tester suggested a place to buy and sell records.

What changed
The Marketplace
Second-hand records with ownership transfer, now earning an 8% fee.

Built 17 Oct

Feedback
A tester wanted to share records and see what friends play.

What changed
Friends
Profiles, activity, badges and listening rooms. It also feeds the sharing plans.

Built 19 Oct

Feedback
A tester said the Puck at £70 was too expensive.

What changed
Puck from £30
Down from £70, with bundles: 2 for £50, 3 for £75.

Changed 19 Oct

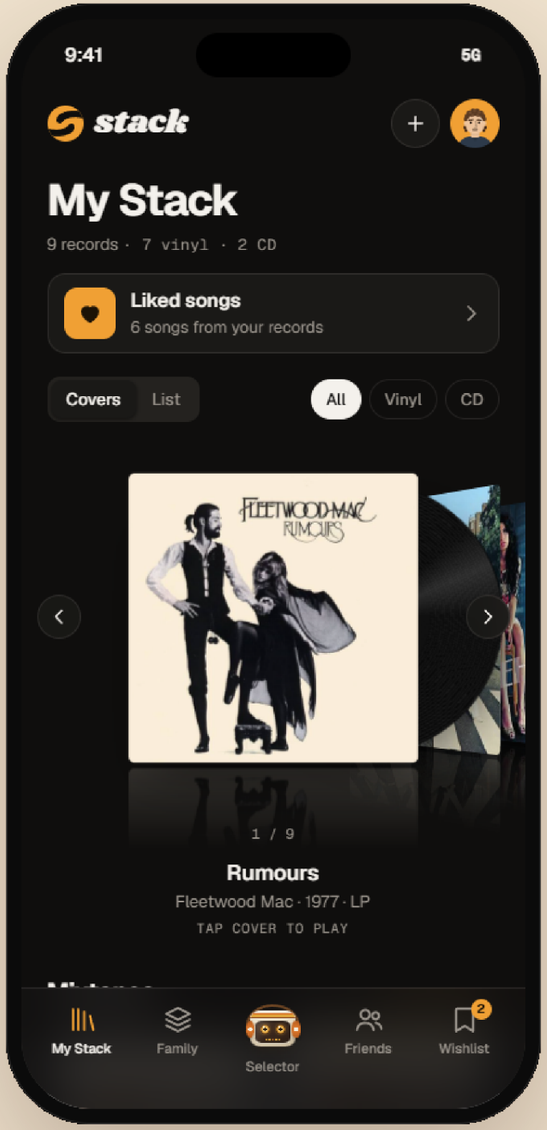
12 Before and after

One tester, a whole new look.

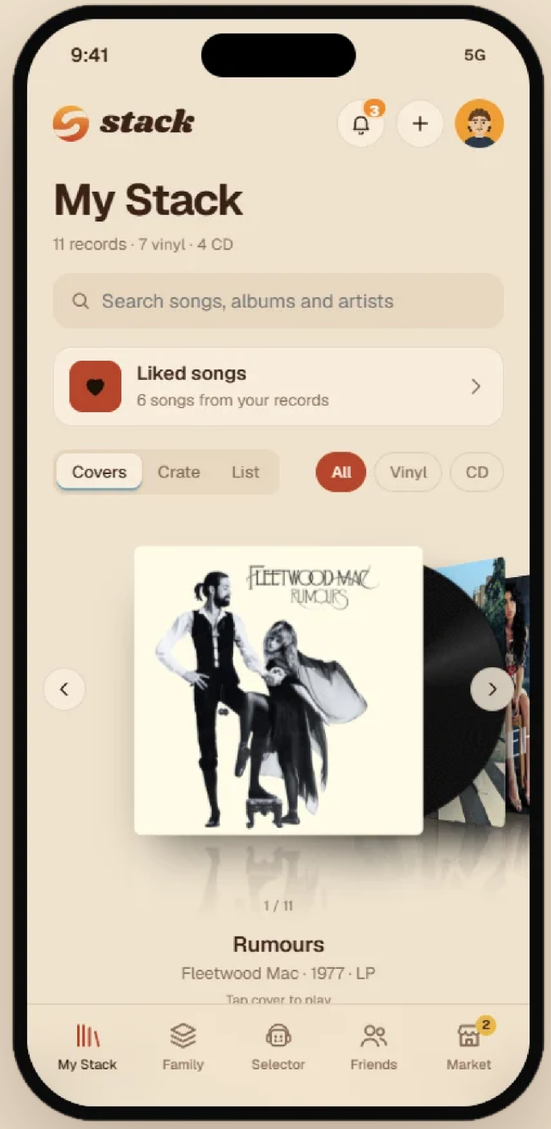
A tester said the black and orange looked like an adult website's branding, so Stack moved to warm 70s colours.

Also new since

Crate view beside Covers and List	8 Oct
Search across your records	8 Oct
Notification bell for mixtapes, loans and reminders	9 Oct
Market tab in place of Wishlist	17 Oct
A new Selector button in the tab bar	



Before
Black and orange



After
Warm 70s palette

13 Founder testing

Using it every day, fixing what I found.

Most changes came from testing the app myself. Every change is dated in the GitHub history.

8 Oct
Browsing covers one by one was slow
Crate view, search and A to Z dividers

8–9 Oct
Sound failed on iPhone
Fixed audio and the two-deck player

9 Oct
My Stack felt cluttered
Notification bell for mixtapes, loans and reminders

9 Oct
Every record looked the same
Vinyl colour picker for real pressings

19 Oct
Marketplace was too basic
Search, grading, offers, chat and price history

21–22 Oct
Paying to play your own records felt wrong
Solo made free; pay only to share

What people do, not just what they say.

Public evidence for and against Stack. Some is US data or older, so it is indicative only.

Supports Stack

Half of US vinyl buyers don’t own a record player

People buy records to own them, and listen elsewhere

Jones (2023)

Supports Stack

Collectors want records on their phones, but home digitising “takes an awful lot of patience”

Doing it yourself is slow, which supports the Puck

RichD1 (2020)

Pushes back

Under 25% of vinyl download codes are ever redeemed

Most buyers may not want a digital copy. Stack has to offer more: sharing, the crate and the Marketplace

Henshall (2019)

Pushes back

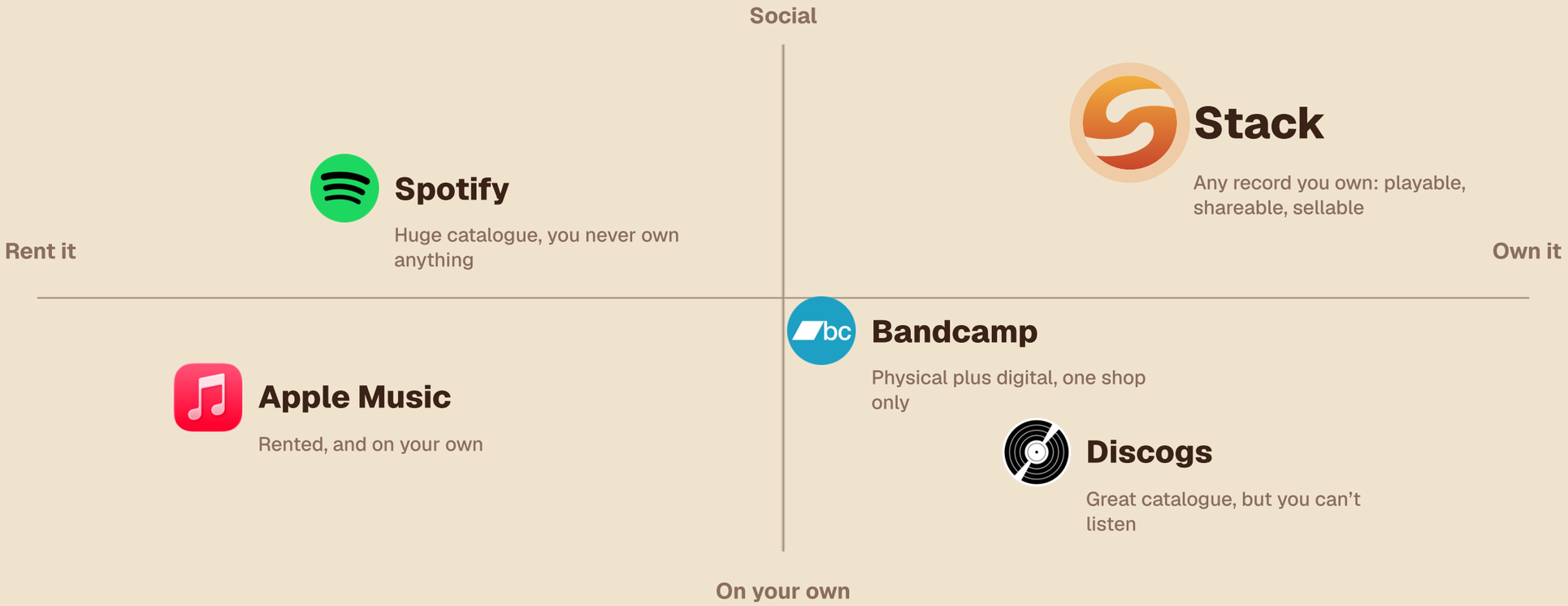
A vinyl-to-phone recording app already existed in 2017, charging per track

The idea isn’t new. The Puck works with any turntable, and the app is free

Roberts (2017)

15 Competitors

Other apps do one thing.
Stack does all three.



16 Launch

Start in Manchester, grow from record shops.

Year 1

Manchester

40,000

people on Stack

5,000 shared homes

12 partner shops

Partner record shops, students and Record Store Day

Year 2

The North West

200,000

people on Stack

25,000 shared homes

45 partner shops

Liverpool, Leeds and Sheffield shops join

Year 3

The UK

640,000

people on Stack

80,000 shared homes

150 partner shops

Label partnerships and the Puck in stores



First users come from the shop counter.

Shops from Manchester's Finest (2026).

Weeks 1 to 4

Sign the first shops

- Visit Vinyl Exchange, Clampdown, Tasty Records, Music For The Soul and Wax and Beans
- Offer to list their second-hand stock on Stack for free

Goal: 2 pilot shops signed

Weeks 5 to 8

Fill the Marketplace

- List shop stock with photo quick-add: snap the cover, AI finds the record and price
- Stickers and posters in both shops

Goal: first 3–5 users from shop customers

Weeks 9 to 12

Grow from the counter

- Listening party at a partner shop
- Invite a friend: you both get a month free
- Offer Seller Pro to pilot shops

Goal: 100 people, 10 paying homes

Out in the world, and on every phone.



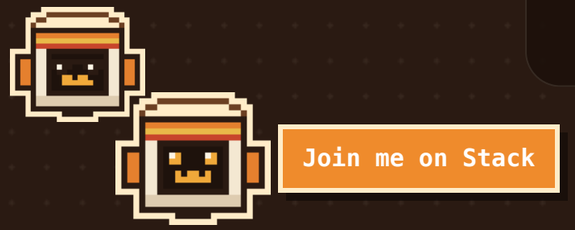
Physical

Out in the world

- Stickers and posters in partner record shops
- Record Store Day events and listening parties
- The Puck on shop counters
- Stack Supply clothing and tote bags





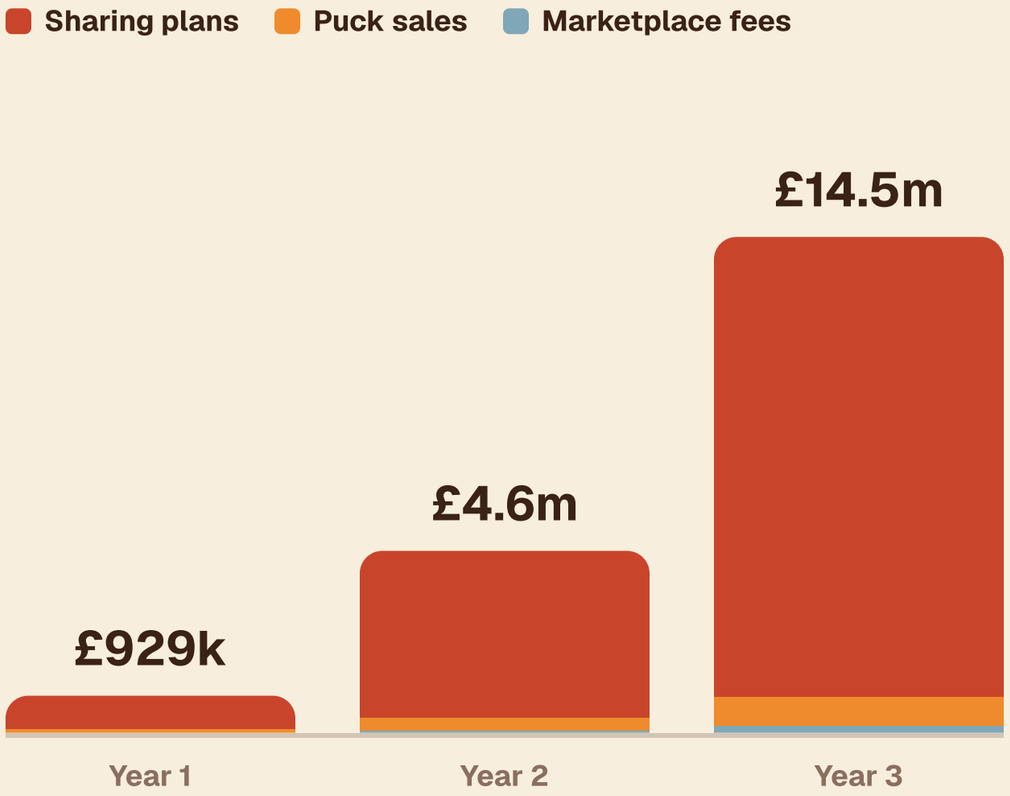


Digital

On every phone

- TikTok and Instagram campaigns
- Music creators and DJs showing their Stacks
- Shareable Stack Wrapped and Record Club picks
- Invite a friend, you both get a month free

How Stack makes money.



	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
People on Stack	40,000	200,000	640,000
Shared homes paying	5,000	25,000	80,000
Sharing plans	£840k	£4.2m	£13.4m
Puck sales	£80k	£320k	£880k
Marketplace fees	£10k	£48k	£154k
Total	**£929k**	**£4.6m**	**£14.5m**

Based on the assumptions on the next page. Stack Supply and record shop commission come on top.

How Year 1 adds up.

Starting from 40,000 people on Stack in Manchester.

Sharing plans — £840k

1 in 8 people share a Stack at home: 40,000 × 12.5% = 5,000 homes × £14.00 a month (60% Duo at £10, 40% Family at £19.99) × 12

Puck sales — £80k

40% of new shared homes buy one: 5,000 × 40% = 2,000 homes × £40 average spend, with bundles

Marketplace fees — £10k

Each shared home buys about £24 of second-hand records a year: 5,000 × £24 = £120k sold × 8%

Year 1 total — £929k

Solo is free, so the other 87.5% of people pay nothing to play their own records.

Break-even in Q3 of Year 1.

Year 1 costs £935k against £929k of revenue. Stack turns a monthly profit from Q3, and cash bottoms out at −£70k.

Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
−£6k	+£414k	+£1.9m

Rights share: Spotify pays about two-thirds (Del Fabbro, 2025). Card fees: Stripe 1.5% + 20p (Hammond, 2026). Other costs are estimates.

Year 1 costs

Rights holders 70% of sharing revenue, slightly above Spotify's two-thirds	**£588k**
Puck parts and shipping £24 a Puck, 1.5 Pucks per buying home	**£72k**
Team Founder, a developer and a shop partnerships lead	**£118k**
Marketing Shop events, stickers, social ads	**£60k**
Hosting, payments, overheads Lossless storage, card fees, legal, insurance	**£97k**
Total	**£935k**

Cashflow, Year 1

	In or out	Cash
Pilot	−£30k	**−£30k**
Q1	−£29k	**−£59k**
Q2	−£11k	**−£70k**
Q3	+£8k	**−£62k**
Q4	+£26k	**−£36k**

Year 1 scenarios

Bad: half the homes, fewer Pucks	**−£128k**
Expected	**−£6k**
Good: 50% more homes	**+£114k**

Not the profit. It brings people in.

At £30 the Puck sells close to cost. Sharing plans make the money; the Puck gets records onto Stack.

Estimates at 1,000 units. Sources: LionCircuits (no date); Andertons (no date); michaelkellett (2013); Einstein (2015).

Parts per Puck

Wi-Fi and Bluetooth chip	£4.70
Audio converter and preamp	£3–5
Board, sockets and assembly	£4–6
Case	£2–4
Box and insert	£1–2
Total	£15–22

Sells for
£30

Left per Puck
£8–15
before shipping and the shop's cut

One-off costs
£15k
Safety testing about £5k, case mould about £10k

23 Legal, ethics, sustainability

Doing it properly, from day one.

Music licensing

Stack streams only records you prove you own, under licences from labels and publishers, with royalties on every play. No licence, no launch.

Data and GDPR

Collections, listening and location are personal data: consent, UK storage, export and delete at any time.

Puck safety

UKCA and CE marking, safety testing, and WEEE take-back for old electronics.

Marketplace fairness

Consumer rights on second-hand sales, payment held until the record arrives, honest grading.

Fair to artists

Every play pays royalties, so sharing your records still pays the people who made them.

Sustainability

Selling records on keeps vinyl in use. The Puck has a recycled case, minimal packaging and a repair-first approach.

24 Risks

The risks, and the answers.

Risk

Music rights

Owning a record doesn’t give you the right to stream or copy it.

Answer

Partner with labels

Many records already come with a download code. Stack becomes its home, licensed, with royalties on every play.

Risk

Hardware costs

Making, certifying and shipping the Puck is expensive.

Answer

Start small, keep it optional

Barcode and Discogs import work without it. The Puck launches in small batches through record shops.

Risk

An empty marketplace

Buyers won’t come without sellers, and the other way round.

Answer

Launch city by city

Manchester first, with partner record shops listing second-hand stock from day one.

25 Capability

Already built, not just planned.

Stack isn’t an idea on paper. These are live now.

A working app

Collection, two-deck player, Family Stack, Friends and Marketplace, all usable today

A full brand

Logo, DJ Selector, stickers, merch and brand guidelines

A film and pitch site

The intro film and an interactive pitch site

Tested and changed

11 testers aged 20 to 65, and six changes made from feedback

£100,000

to make the first Pucks, launch in Manchester and reach break-even.

Next milestone, by month 6

5 partner shops · 1,000 people on Stack · 125 paying homes

First 500 Pucks 500 × about £20 in parts	**£10,000**
Case mould A one-off for the Puck body	**£10,000**
Safety testing UKCA and CE marking	**£5,000**
Manchester pilot Stickers, posters, listening parties	**£3,000**
Hosting and licensing Running the pilot	**£2,000**
Working capital Covers losses until break-even in Q3 of Year 1, with a buffer	**£70,000**
Total Pre-seed from an angel investor, plus a Start Up Loan	**£100,000**

Own it.
Play it everywhere.



Try the prototype: **harrisongreener.github.io/stack**
Pitch site: **harrisongreener.github.io/stackPitch**

Harrison Greener · Student ID 214313327

Sources

References.

Andertons (no date) *Behringer UFO202 USB audio interface*. Available at: https://www.andertons.co.uk/behringer-ufo202-usb-audio-interface (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

BPI (2026) *New generation of British artists helped UK recorded music market in 2025 surpass £1.5 billion in annual revenue for the first time*. 12 March. Available at: https://www.bpi.co.uk/news/13097053 (Accessed: 23 October 2026).

Del Fabbro, L. (2025) 'Spotify breaks record with largest annual payout reaching 10 billion dollars', *The Irish News*, 12 March. Available at: https://www.irishnews.com/entertainment/spotify-breaks-record-with-largest-annual-payout-reaching-10-billion-dollars-SHAB4WWOOJKNJDYCOAPBEAZ7OY/ (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

Einstein, B. (2015) 'Will your hardware startup make money?', *TechSpot*, 1 September. Available at: https://www.techspot.com/news/61952-hardware-startup-make-money.html (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

Hammond, A. (2026) 'Stripe payment fees explained: full breakdown and hidden costs', *Airwallex*, 2 February. Available at: https://www.airwallex.com/en-uk/blog/stripe-payment-fees-explained (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

Henshall, M. (2019) 'Are vinyl download cards dead?', *Sound Matters*, 30 September. Available at: https://yoursoundmatters.com/are-vinyl-download-cards-dead (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

Jones, A. (2023) 'Half of vinyl buyers in the US don't have a record player, new study shows', *Consequence*, 28 April. Available at: https://consequence.net/2023/04/half-vinyl-buyers-record-player-study/ (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

LionCircuits (no date) *ESP32-S3-WROOM-1-N8R8*. Available at: https://lioncircuits.com/parts/ESP32-S3-WROOM-1-N8R8 (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

Manchester's Finest (2026) *Manchester's best independent record shops*, 7 January. Available at: https://www.manchestersfinest.com/manchester-guides/manchesters-best-independent-record-shops/ (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

Marsden, B. (2026) 'Vinyl sales in the UK reach their highest point in more than three decades', *Dork*, 24 April. Available at: https://readdork.com/news/uk-vinyl-sales-highest-level-three-decades-bpi-report (Accessed: 23 October 2026).

Maurya, A. (2012) *Running lean: iterate from plan A to a plan that works*. 2nd edn. Sebastopol, CA: O'Reilly.

michaelkellett (2013) 'Re: Cost of regulatory certifications', *element14 Community*. Available at: https://community.element14.com/products/devtools/single-board-computers/f/forum/22148/cost-of-regulatory-certifications (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

RichD1 (2020) 'Digitising my LP's', *What Hi-Fi? Forum*, 11 December. Available at: https://forums.whathifi.com/threads/digitising-my-lps.116922/ (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

Ries, E. (2011) *The lean startup*. London: Portfolio Penguin.

Roberts, B. (2017) 'Want to record vinyl to your phone? There's an app for that', *What Hi-Fi?*, 11 August. Available at: https://www.whathifi.com/news/want-to-record-vinyl-to-your-phone-theres-app (Accessed: 26 October 2026).

Competitor logos belong to their owners. Album artwork in screenshots belongs to the artists and labels.